



Zoo Explorers

Meet the African Elephant!

Vulnerable

Facts • Colour • Activities

African Elephant Fact File ■

Scientific name:	Loxodonta africana / Loxodonta cyclotis
Status:	Vulnerable
Where they live:	37 countries across Sub-Saharan Africa
Habitat:	Savannas, forests, deserts, and wetlands across Sub-Saharan Africa
Diet:	Herbivore — grasses, leaves, bark, fruit; up to 150 kg of food per day
Weight:	4,000–7,000 kg
Lifespan:	Up to 70 years in the wild
Population:	Around 415,000 (bush); around 100,000 (forest)

Amazing Facts ■

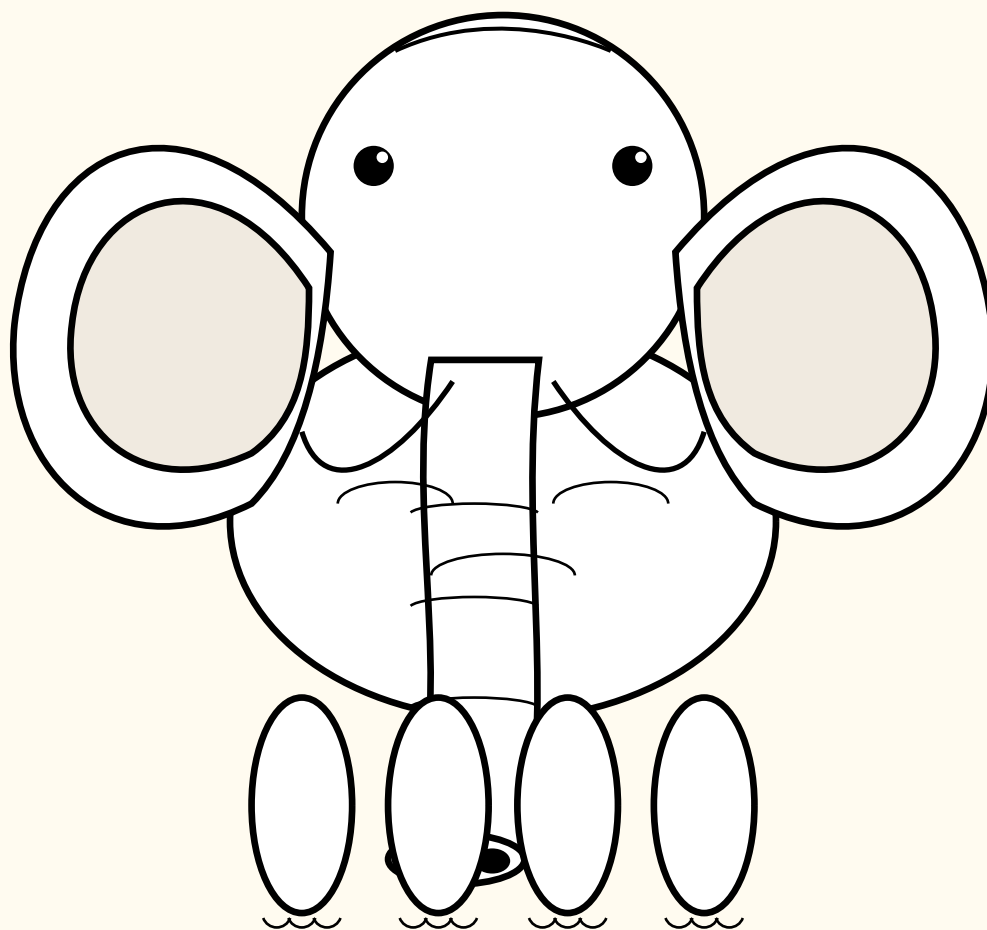
- African elephants are the largest land animals on Earth — a male can weigh 7,000 kg.
- An elephant's trunk is about 2 m long and has around 40,000 muscles.
- They suck up to 7.5 litres of water into their trunk at once, then blow it into their mouth.
- Elephants use their large ears like fans to cool down in the African heat.
- They live in herds led by the oldest female, called the matriarch.
- Elephants are hunted mainly for their ivory tusks — which is illegal worldwide.

Threats ■■

#	Threat	Impact
1	Poaching for ivory tusks	CRITICAL
2	Habitat loss as savannas and forests become farmland	HIGH
3	Human-elephant conflict over crops and water	HIGH
4	Climate change reducing water and food availability	MODERATE

Colour Me! — African Elephant

African elephants are grey with deeply wrinkled skin. Their large fan-shaped ears are lighter underneath.



Activities ➡

Word Search — find all 8 words!

P	F	T	U	S	K	T	Q	O	D	Q	Q
O	K	I	R	K	J	T	X	E	S	K	P
A	I	V	O	R	Y	Z	R	D	A	L	D
C	C	P	N	D	U	E	E	Y	V	O	H
H	N	S	C	P	G	F	L	V	A	Y	B
I	O	V	D	N	O	D	E	A	N	W	L
N	Y	A	A	I	R	Y	P	N	N	T	C
G	W	D	F	E	A	O	H	B	A	S	C
N	N	Z	H	R	U	P	A	K	R	C	X
E	U	N	N	C	I	E	N	Y	Y	Q	B
Y	F	Q	Q	Q	Z	C	T	I	K	O	H
X	C	J	D	U	Z	A	A	W	Z	C	V

ELEPHANT	IVORY	SAVANNA	ENDANGERED
AFRICA	TUSK	POACHING	HERD

Match It Up!

African Elephant		the female leader of the herd
Tusk		largest land animal
Herd		illegal hunting for ivory
Poaching		a family group of elephants
Matriarch		long ivory tooth

Fill in the Blanks!

- Elephants are the largest _____ animals on Earth.
- They are hunted illegally for their _____ tusks.
- An elephant's trunk has around _____ muscles.
- African elephants can live up to _____ years.

Answers: land | ivory | 40,000 | 70

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